Beef Tenderloin with Creamy Mushroom Sauce

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

A beautifully seared steak with a generous spoonful of mushroom sauce makes a lovely meal to share around the table.

Serves 4 · Prep 15 min · Cook 25 min

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE STEAK

- 4 Australian beef tenderloin steaks, approximately 180–200 g each
- Salt and freshly ground black pepper
- 2 tbsp butter

FOR THE MUSHROOM SAUCE

- 2 tbsp butter
- 4 sprigs fresh French thyme, leaves picked
- 150 g brown beech mushrooms, woody bases trimmed and clusters separated
- 250 g champignons de Paris (button mushrooms), sliced
- 1 tbsp beef stock concentrate
- ½ cup low-sodium soy sauce
- Freshly ground black pepper, to taste
- 1½ tbsp tartufata (truffle paste)
- 2 cups crème fraîche

TO SERVE

- French fries, potato purée or smashed potatoes *(optional)*

METHOD

1. Prepare the steaks. Pat the steaks thoroughly dry with kitchen paper and season with salt and black pepper.
2. Brown the mushrooms. Melt the butter for the sauce in a large frying pan over medium-high heat. Add the button mushrooms and brown beech mushrooms, working in batches if needed. Cook until their moisture has evaporated and they begin to turn golden.
3. Add the thyme leaves and stir for about a minute. Stir in the beef stock concentrate and soy sauce, scraping up any browned bits from the pan.
4. Reduce the heat to low and stir in the crème fraîche. Simmer gently until the sauce comes together and thickens slightly. Stir in the tartufata and season with black pepper. Taste before adding any salt, as the soy sauce and stock already provide plenty. Keep warm over very low heat.
5. Cook the steaks. Heat a heavy frying pan over medium-high heat. Add the butter and, once foaming, add the steaks. Sear on both sides, adjusting the heat to keep the butter from burning. Continue cooking to your preferred doneness; the timing will depend on the thickness of the steaks.
6. Transfer the steaks to a warm plate and leave to rest for 5–10 minutes. Stir any resting juices into the mushroom sauce.
7. Serve the steaks with a generous spoonful of sauce and your choice of potatoes.

Tip

Dry the steaks well. A dry surface helps them develop a beautiful crust.